

20 Things that might happen

There are many ways to talk about hypothetical future situations. You can use different structures to indicate whether you think a hypothesis is likely or unlikely.

⚙️ **New language** "What if," "suppose," "in case"

Aa **Vocabulary** Exams and assessment

👤 **New skill** Talking about hypothetical situations

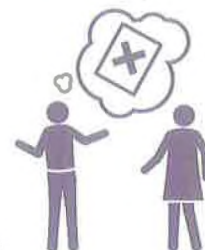
20.1 KEY LANGUAGE LIKELY TO HAPPEN

If a future outcome is likely to happen, you can use "what if," "suppose," and "in case" followed by the present tense to express it.

"What if" means "what would happen if a hypothetical situation occurred?"

Present tense shows the speaker believes this is likely to happen.

**What if I fail my exams?
I won't be able to go to college.**



20.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES LIKELY TO HAPPEN

"Suppose" refers to the consequences of a hypothetical situation.

**Suppose they assess our coursework.
We will have to keep a portfolio.**

We should start organizing our project work in case they want to see it.

"In case" refers to being prepared for the hypothetical situation.



20.3 MATCH THE SITUATIONS TO THE LIKELY CONSEQUENCES

What if we don't pass our exams?

Maybe you could apply for funding.

① I'm going to take a water bottle

in case the exam room is hot.

② Suppose you cannot afford to study.

Maybe we'll have to take them again.

③ I am studying really hard tonight

Maybe they will have spares.

④ What if I forget to bring a calculator?

in case we have a test tomorrow.

